a new culture, dominated by people who called themselves Arya and who revered sacred texts they called the Vedas, chanted in a sacerdotal language called Sanskrit. There was no inward migration, this theory further maintains, but there was an outward migration, during which the Arya exported their language westwards, so that it is quite correct to call this now widespread language group 'Indo-European' – because it began in India and spread to Europe.

Such revisionism flies in the face of all the evidence – archaeogenetic, archaeological, linguistic, zoological, botanical, geographical and theological – but so seriously is it being promoted that it has to be challenged, albeit as succinctly as I can.

In the previous chapter I referred to mitochondrial DNA and the presence of the two Haplogroups M and N in the DNA of most Indian women. But haplogroups also occur in the male Y chromosome. For example, the Y chromosome Haplogroup H is believed to have originated in India some forty thousand years ago and is still prevalent there.[12] But within this same Y chromosome is Haplogroup R, one particular branch (or subclade) of which, known as Haplogroup R1a1a, is far more widespread than the other subclades. Its highest concentrations are found among Eastern Europeans but also in Western Mongolia, Tajikistan, Southern Uzbekistan, Eastern Iran, Afghanistan and Pakistan, here particularly among the Pashtuns, Sindhis, Baltis and Kashmiris. Within modern India, high percentages of Subclade R1a1a are found among West Bengal Brahmins, Konkanastha Brahmins and Iyengar Brahmins, but also among the Khatris of the Punjab – Punjabi traders who have always claimed superior caste status as Kshatriyas, all the Sikh gurus being Khatris – and among the Madeshis on both sides of the India–Nepal border (see Map 3).[13]